

Carved tools

Early *Homo sapiens* was a much more skillful toolmaker than other hominins (human relatives). As early as 73,000 years ago, humans in southern Africa were carving finely made tools from bone and making jewelry from shells. By 18,000 years ago, humans in Europe were using bone, ivory, and caribou antlers to make spear throwers, harpoons, and even needles. Many of these were engraved with artistic designs, such as animal heads.

Spear thrower

Harpoons

Spear points

Bone and antler tools from ice age Europe

Needle



▲ THE BUSHMEN of southern Africa follow a way of life known as hunter-gathering. Instead of keeping livestock for food or growing crops, they gather all their food from the wild. All early *Homo sapiens* were hunter-gatherers, too. This way of life did not begin to die out until farming began about 8,000 years ago.